

Island king

All known fossils of *Hatzegopteryx* have been discovered in modern-day Romania, in a region that formed an island called Hațeg during the Late Cretaceous Period. Since no evidence of other large theropods has been found there, paleontologists believe that *Hatzegopteryx* was probably the top predator on this island.

The shape of *Hatzegopteryx*'s long beak resembles those of modern ground hornbills and storks.

STATS AND FACTS

Fossils show that *Hatzegopteryx*'s skull was one of the largest of all the ground-dwelling animals discovered so far. Estimated to be 5–8 ft (1.6–2.5 m) long, its skull was about the same height as an Asian elephant.

BONE THICKNESS



Hatzegopteryx's bones were about $\frac{1}{4}$ – $\frac{1}{2}$ in (4–6 mm) thick.

WEIGHT



At 440–550 lb (200–250 kg), *Hatzegopteryx* was quite light for its size.